



**BHAWANI (LEFT)
AND JAI SINGH**



**THE CREMATION
SITE OF RAJMATA
GAYATRI DEVI
IN JAIPUR**

the grandchildren and himself closer to Gayatri Devi during the past one year. Both he and Gayatri Devi began visiting each other's palaces after many years.

The rift within the family began in 1986 when Jagat demanded an equal share in the property inherited by Bhawani as the eldest son. The demand for equal partition meant Jai and Prithvi Raj also becoming a party to it and subsequently, Prem Kanwar, Bhawani's sister did also. Now, with the latest twist in the case, observers of royalty in Jaipur are wondering if there is an understanding between the grandchildren and Bhawani by which they will get a major share in Gayatri Devi's legacy but surrender their rights in Bhawani's share.

While all three stepbrothers have chosen to maintain a studied silence over the affair, the grandchildren have no such qualms. Devraj, her grandson and Lalitya Devi, her granddaughter, met media personnel and handed over a single-page brief staking claim to a will that gives them all the rights to Gayatri Devi's property. Devraj refused to read the brief on camera. Journalists demanded he display the letter in his hand which he did rather reluctantly. Only two weeks earlier, media were told that a will was to be made public on August 9 but when they gathered in huge numbers at the City Palace, they were uncereemoniously told that nothing like this was promised and even asked by members of the family: "Who told you that a will even exists?"

However, a week later, the same people attempted to claim that a will of sorts existed. This will is only going to make things messier with opponents likely to question its authenticity and even raise questions as to whether Gayatri Devi was in a correct frame of mind while signing it. The

GAYATRI DEVI'S GRANDCHILDREN HAVE PRODUCED A SINGLE-PAGE BRIEF STAKING CLAIM TO THE PROPERTY BUT THE COMPLEX WEB OF ROYAL HIERARCHY AND TRUSTS RAISES MANY QUESTIONS.

